

Introduction to CSS

Full Stack: Frontend, Backend, Database & Deployment · Class 11

What is CSS?

- HTML gives a page structure — headings, paragraphs, lists
- CSS gives a page style — colors, fonts, spacing, layout
- CSS = Cascading Style Sheets
- Without CSS, every page looks plain black-on-white text

CSS Syntax

- `selector { property: value; }`
- Selector — which element(s) to style
- Property — what to change (`color`, `background-color`, ...)
- Value — what to change it to

Inline CSS

- Written directly on one element with the `style` attribute
- `<h1 style="color: blue;">`
- Fast for a one-off test
- Only affects that single element

Writing Colors Three Ways

- Keyword — `red`
- Hex — `#ff0000`
- RGB — `rgb(255, 0, 0)`
- All three describe the exact same color

The Problem With Inline CSS

- Six `<h1>` tags, same style repeated six times
- Copy-pasting `style="color: blue;"` everywhere is tedious
- One typo in one copy and that heading breaks the pattern
- There has to be a better way to style many elements at once

Internal CSS & Tag Selectors

- `<style>` block placed inside `<head>`
- `h1 { color: blue; }` styles every `<h1>` on the page, once
- A tag selector targets every element of that tag
- One rule, unlimited matching elements

ID Selector — One Specific Element

- `#special { color: teal; }` in the `<style>` block
- Pair it with `id="special"` on exactly one element
- IDs are unique — only one element should ever share an id
- Use it when exactly one element needs its own look

Class Selector — A Group of Elements

- `.highlight { color: orange; }` in the `<style>` block
- Pair it with `class="highlight"` on any number of elements
- Classes are reusable across many elements
- Use it when a group of elements should share a look

ID vs. Class

- `id` — one element, one-of-a-kind, `#` in CSS
- `class` — many elements, reusable, `.` in CSS

`#special (id)`



exactly one element

`.highlight (class)`



any number of elements

External CSS

- Copying the same `<style>` block into every page doesn't scale to 10 pages
- Move the rules into their own file — `style.css`
- Link it from every page: `<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">`
- One file styles the entire site — edit once, every page updates

Block vs. Inline Elements

- Block elements (like `<div>`) start on a new line, take the full width
- Inline elements (like `<span>`) sit inside the text flow
- `width` and `height` only affect block elements
- Inline elements are only as wide as their content

`<div>` — block

full available width, own line

next block starts on a new line below

`<span>` — inline

This sentence has a `highlighted word` sitting right in the flow of text.

Choosing the Right CSS Method

- Quick one-off test on one element — inline
- Styling a single page — internal
- Styling a whole multi-page site — external
- Same CSS knowledge, three different delivery methods

Extra Activity: Anchor Links with `id`

- The `id` attribute isn't just for CSS — it's also a landmark on the page
- `<h2 id="contact">Contact</h2>` marks a spot
- `<a href="#contact">Jump to Contact</a>` links straight to it
- Try it: add ids to a few sections, then build a jump-link menu at the top